KITE FIRST · THEN WING, SURF, MTB AND MX

HI8CTANE

THE GOOD DAYS. THE RIGHT PEOPLE. A SEAT IN THE CAR.

Pre-seed · €250K · 15 months · November 2026

Francisco Arredondo, founder · hi8ctane.com · hello@hi8ctane.com

GOING ALONE IS WHY PEOPLE DON’T GO

KNOWING

A good window is a few hours long, and it’s only known a day or two ahead.

MATCHING

You shouldn’t ride alone, and you need people at your level who are free that day.

GOING

The spot is 30 to 120 minutes away, with a kite and a board, and there’s no car.

So they check a forecast app, a WhatsApp group and a carpool site, and stay home.

Good conditions don’t turn into a session on their own. That gap is the business.

FOUR PEOPLE WE BUILD FOR

Who	Today	With Hi8ctane
The city rider without a car	Sees 20 knots on the app, finds no lift, stays home	A seat from Sants to Sant Pere Pescador for €9.95, room for the board
The newcomer	New in town, and the local groups are closed or asleep	A crew at their level on the first good weekend
The beginner	Did a course, then stopped: nobody to ride with	A rookie crew with a captain, and a partner school for the next step
The driver with empty seats	Drives alone and pays €39.81 in fuel	Three riders cover three quarters of it, and help to launch and land

Prices from the app: Sants to Sant Pere Pescador and back, fuel at this week’s price, 4 in the car

THE INSIGHT

THE WEATHER OPENS A WINDOW OF A FEW HOURS.
NOBODY SHOULD RIDE IT ALONE.

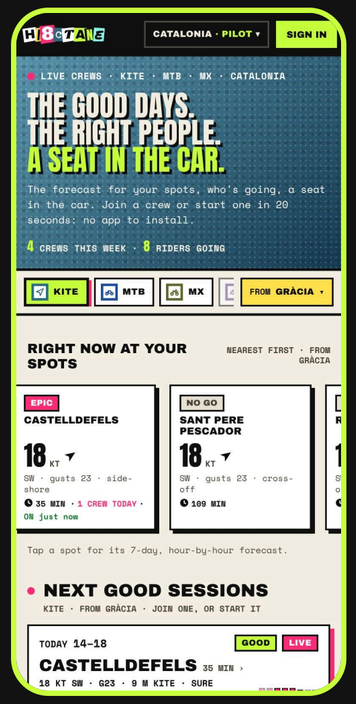
The first rule of kite safety is never kite alone, and the same goes for a trail or a track. The crew isn’t a nice-to-have: it’s how these sports work. Nobody puts the window, the crew and the seat together. Hi8ctane does.

Safety rules: VDWS, IKSA

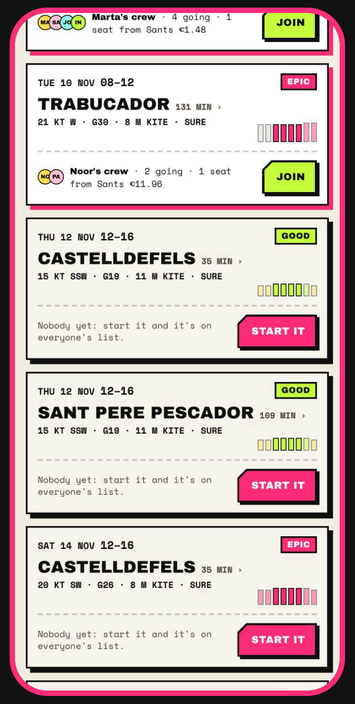
THE SOLUTION

CONDITIONS, CREW AND CAR IN ONE FLOW

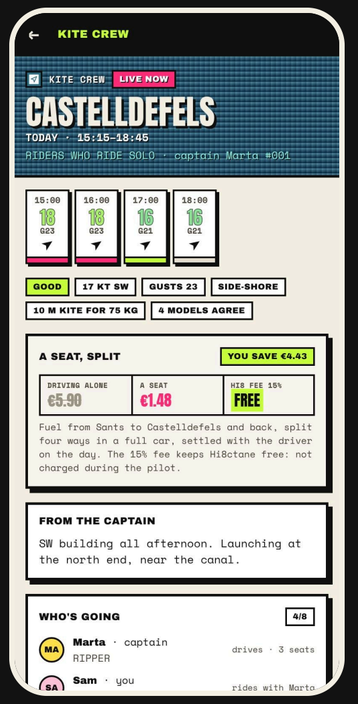
- Matched by where you set off
- Riders at a compatible level
- Seats, with room for the gear
- The fuel split, worked out
- Join, confirm, check in
- Plan B when it’s not on



1 · Right now



2 · Join or start



3 · Your seat



4 · The route

WHAT WORKS TODAY, END TO END

FORECAST
4 models, 7 days

SESSION
Best spot near you

CREW
Start or join, by level

SEAT
Split, pick-ups, route

CHECK-IN
At the spot, counted

REPORT
How it really was

12
releases in 25 days

400+
automated checks on every release

0
public users yet: the beta comes first

Built but switched off: card payments, the wallet and the Pass (until a legal review). **Next:** the store apps, room for gear in each car, reporting and blocking a rider, email reminders on our sending key.

WHAT MAKES A CREW WORK

MATCHING

By sport, level and where you start. Beginners only see days and spots that suit them.

PLAN B

No wind? The app suggests what still works: a ride, a track day, a cable session. Leaving and refunds are built in.

THE SPLIT · DRIVERS NEVER PROFIT

Fuel shared by everyone in the car. Riders add a 15% Hi8 fee, waived with the Pass and free in the pilot.

SAFETY

A captain on every rookie crew, so first-timers never go out alone. Nobody sees where you live.

Captains host one crew a week and ride alongside. They never teach: lessons go to partner schools.

A MULTI-SPORT PRODUCT. ONE SPORT AT A TIME.

1 · NOW

KITE

Where we acquire and prove it: the hardest logistics, the most need for a crew.

2 · NEXT

WING, SUP, SURF

The same spots and riders, plus windsurf: the second sport they discover with us.

3 · TEST

MTB

A community experiment, and the flat-day Plan B for kiters.

4 · BUILD BIG

MX

Its own community: tracks, €180 days, big names, high spend per rider.

All five run on the same engine today. Marketing, hosts and partners go to one sport until it hits 20 verified outings.

WHY RIDERS COME BACK EVERY WEEK

LIVE

GOOD-DAY ALERTS

A ping when a crew posts for your sport, with seats left.

LIVE

REPORTS FROM THE SPOT

Riders check in and say how it really is. Better than any forecast.

LIVE

THE NIGHTS

A session by day, a party by night. The RSVP is the sign-up.

NEXT

RIDE AGAIN

Keep the crew. Next good day, the same people in one tap.

NEXT

YOUR SEASON

Sessions, streaks, km shared and euros saved, ready to post.

NEXT

REPUTATION UNLOCKS

Good check-ins unlock trips, co-living rates and athlete crews.

The metric we live by: riders back out within 30 days

WHY NOW

KITE WENT OLYMPIC

Formula Kite debuted at Paris 2024, with a Dutch rider on the women's podium. 300,000 people kited in the Netherlands in 2023.

SPORT IS SOCIAL NOW

Strava saw run clubs grow 59% in 2024. People would rather meet through a sport than at a bar.

TINY TEAMS SHIP

Open weather models rate every spot every hour, and AI-assisted engineering shipped this app in 23 days.

The market pays for this: Strava was valued at $2.2B in 2025 and filed for an IPO in January 2026.

Sources: Nautica News, NOS (NKV 2023), Strava Year in Sport 2024, Built In (May 2025), Endurance Sportswire (Jan 2026)

OTHERS HELP RIDERS MEET. HI8CTANE GETS THEM THERE.

	When it's good	Who, at my level	A seat in a car	From my town
Forecast apps: Windguru, Windy, Surfline	Yes	–	–	–
Strava clubs, Meetup	–	Partly: clubs	–	Partly
Duotone's Academy app, Spotties	Partly	Partly: at the spot	–	–
WhatsApp and Facebook groups	–	Partly	Partly	Yes
BlaBlaCar	–	–	City to city	–
Hi8ctane	**Yes:** 4 models	**Yes:** by level	**Yes:** routed	**Yes:** any town

Conditions + compatibility + logistics + a completed session. We count outings, not downloads.

From what each product says publicly, November 2026

HOW BIG IT CAN GET

100K+

regular kitesurfers in the Netherlands alone, and 300K who kited in 2023 (NKV)

€3,800

a new kiter's first year: €499 to learn, about €1,800 for a kit, €1,490 for a week in Tarifa

€87K

a year from one mature Hi8ctane city, with 69% left after city costs (our model)

BOTTOM-UP: €87K A CITY × THE CITIES WE OPEN

Base case: 10 cities ≈ €0.9M a year, 25 ≈ €2.2M, 100 ≈ €8.7M. Kite first; the other sports join each city once kite works.

Sources: NOS (NKV 2021, 2023), KBC, Surfertoday, Yumping. City figures are model targets.

FREE TO JOIN. PAID TO GO FURTHER.

Tier	Price	What it is
1 · Bookings	10–15% take	Lessons, rentals, experiences like the MX day, trips and co-living, paid in the app
2 · Partner pilots	Paid by partners	Weather-triggered offers and activations: we fill their quiet days
Free for riders	€0	The 7-day forecast, every crew, chat, alerts, starting a crew
3 · A seat	Fuel share + 15%	About €0.67 a seat (€0.49 minimum). Drivers only share costs
Later · Pass	€3.99 a month	No Hi8 fee on any seat: pays for itself in 6 rides
Later · Club	€9.99 a month	The Pass, plus partner discounts, travel buddies, first access to Nights and trips

Finding a crew is always free. Never: sell rider data or put ads in the feed.

Bookings and partner pilots come first. The fee, the Pass and the Club switch on as the network grows.

NINE WAYS ONE CITY PAYS

EVENTS + CONTESTS — €17K

Tickets and sponsors: 4 Nights and a contest

MEMBERSHIP — €13.8K

Pass €3.99 and Club €9.99, 3% of sign-ups

BRANDS + UGC — €12K

Presenting partner, demo days, athlete content

RIDE FEE — €10K

15% of the seat, 1,230 paid seats a month

ROOKIE → LESSON — €9.5K

15% of a €350 course, 15 learners a month

SECOND-HAND GEAR — €7.2K

5% buyer protection, money held until handover

EXPERIENCES — €6.8K

MX day €180 all in, cable parks, guided rides

TRIPS + CO-LIVING — €6.5K

10% on camps and stays, for vetted riders only

RENTALS — €4.3K

15% on kites, boards and bikes from partners

A mature city a year: €87K. No stream is more than 20% of it. Model targets, to test in the pilot.

ONE CITY: EVERY ASSUMPTION, THREE CASES

A mature city, its third season · all hypotheses	Conservative	Base	Upside
Reachable riders signed up	3,000	6,000	10,000
Out with a crew in a month	20%	25%	30%
Outings per active rider a month	1.5	2	2.5
Partner bookings per 100 riders out	7	11	14
Hi8 revenue per booking	€14	€18	€20
Paying members, of sign-ups	2%	3%	4%
Events, contests and brands a year	€15K	€29K	€45K
Revenue a year	**€30K**	**€87K**	**€201K**
City costs: part-time lead, marketing, ops	-€20K	-€27K	-€35K
Left for the company	**€10K**	**€60K**	**€166K**

Proven so far: none of these, yet. The beta measures the first four rows. Before VAT and payment costs.

THE FIRST MONTH: WHAT THE BETA MUST PROVE

50
selected beta riders

8-10
active crew hosts

20
verified completed outings

3
paid partner pilots

THREE QUESTIONS

1. Do good conditions turn into confirmed sessions?
2. Do riders come back on the next good window?
3. Will local businesses pay for real customers?

FOUR WEEKS

1. Testing, onboarding, 30–50 riders
2. The first real crews and local hosts
3. 10–15 outings, the first partner sales
4. 20 outings, interviews, investor update

Targets, not traction. Amsterdam first, then Barcelona. Verified = 2+ checked in at the spot.

HOW RIDERS FIND US WITHOUT BUYING THEM

EVENTS AND NIGHTS

Francisco has drawn 350+ people to his own events. The RSVP is the sign-up.

150 sign-ups a night

ATHLETES AND UGC

One edit per sport, made by pros people follow and paid for by brands. Every seat needs a sign-up.

5 sport edits, 10 athletes hosting

PARTNERS SEND RIDERS

Schools, rentals, tracks and cable parks list on Hi8ctane and send their customers.

10 partners by spring

CO-LIVING AND TRIPS

Member rates at kite houses and co-livings, for riders we vouch for. Travellers bring Hi8 home.

2 co-living partners

PLATES AND INVITES

100 founding plates a city, and every crew link a captain shares brings friends in.

30% of riders invite someone

ADS ONLY WHEN IT'S ON

Instagram the evening before an epic day; Google when people search how to learn.

Under €8 a sign-up

Targets for the beta, the first six months. No paid ads before 20 verified outings.

PEOPLE THE FOUNDER ALREADY KNOWS

PARTNERS

Who	What they add
An MX track, Barcelona	The MX day, €180 all in (in talks)
A kite school, Tarifa	Kite lessons and camps
A kite-trip operator	Kite stays and trips
A rider co-living	Co-living for riders
Bike rentals, NL	Bikes for MTB crews

RIDERS PEOPLE FOLLOW

Who	Sport
A pro rider	Freeride MTB
A pro rider	Motocross, supercross
A pro rider	Adventure moto, enduro, MX
A pro rider	Surf, downhill MTB, ski
More pros	Kite, ski, freestyle MX, moto

Relationships, not signed commitments yet. The beta turns them into partner pilots and hosted crews.

Riders who host earn advisor shares vesting over two years. Names added as each one signs on.

THE LONG GAME: A RIDING BRAND, BUILT FROM THE COMMUNITY

2027

HI8CTANE TV

Short films of real Hi8ctane days, one series per sport, shot with the riders. Brands pay for the episodes.

2027

CREW DROPS

Limited apparel drops for crews and Nights, printed on demand. No stock risk.

2028+

A NATURAL ENERGY DRINK

Made with a sports-nutrition producer under licence, once the audience is there.

NOW

NIGHTS + MERCH

Founding Nights in Amsterdam and Barcelona, with the first crew merch in small runs.

The big energy brands sold a can, then built media around it. We start with the riders and the media, and sell to them later.

Not in the €250K plan: the app comes first. Merch in small runs now; drops from 2027.

KITE FIRST, CITY BY CITY

How a city opens: kite hosts and 50 selected riders first, then partners. Crews start from any town the moment a rider posts one.

When	City	Why
Now · push	The Amsterdam coastal corridor	Most of the beta: North Sea kite, riders without cars
Now · free	Barcelona and the Empordà	Soft launch, free, left to grow: winter kite, an MX track
Open · push 2027	Tarifa	Europe's kite capital, open in the app now; travellers take Hi8 home
Autumn 2027	Rotterdam, Hamburg	Same coast, same kit; wing and surf join
2028	Lisbon, then Cape Town and the SF Bay	Big scenes, and the other hemisphere's season

The next city or sport opens only after 20 verified outings, then 35% back within 30 days and 10 hosts.

Barcelona beach rules: barcelona.cat (kite banned in bathing zones, 1 June to 30 September)

WHERE WE ARE: BUILT, NOT YET PUBLIC

DONE

- The whole journey built, 400+ automated checks
- Live in Amsterdam, Barcelona and Tarifa
- Partner deck and agreement in EN, ES and NL
- Instagram @hi8ctane_com live

NEXT 30 DAYS

- The Dutch BV, then IP assigned to it
- Beta: 50 riders, first crews, 20 outings
- Submitted to the App Store and Google Play
- 3 founding partners, an MX track among them
- Founding Nights in Amsterdam and Barcelona
- Payments on, after a legal review

TARGETS AFTER THE BETA

	31 Mar	30 Jun
Riders signed up	500	2,000
Completed outings a month	80	300
Active hosts	20	50
Seats filled	60%	70%
Back within 30 days	30%	35%
Partners paying	3	10

Targets, not results. Reported to investors every month.

SAFETY AND TRUST ARE PART OF THE PRODUCT

IN THE APP NOW

- Labelled as a model forecast, with model agreement
- Each spot’s rules: marked zones, offshore winds
- 18+, and beginners see only spots that suit them
- Rookie crews ride with a captain, who never teaches
- Pick-up points, never addresses; starts to ~1 km
- Leaving, calling off and refunds built in

BEFORE PUBLIC LAUNCH

- Report and block a rider
- Age and skill confirmed at sign-up
- Terms: drivers share costs, riders own their call
- Activity and liability insurance, legal review
- Lessons only through certified partner schools
- Payments live only after a payments-law review

A crew never replaces professional instruction. Every session is the rider’s own call.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG, AND OUR ANSWER

Risk	How we handle it
Weather and seasons	Five sports on one engine; MTB and MX need no wind; plans and Nights fill the flat days
“We have WhatsApp”	Groups can’t rate the day, find the seat, route the car or take payment. Captains share our links there
Riders go off-app	The wallet, routes, fee-free seats with the Pass, partner prices and reputation all live in the app
Carpool rules	Drivers only share costs, the model a Madrid court upheld for BlaBlaCar in 2017; our fee is for the platform
Safety and liability	We never teach; rookies ride with a captain; partners carry their own cover; terms and insurance are budgeted
Holding money	Stripe holds and pays out through Connect; the wallet stays off until a payments lawyer signs off

BlaBlaCar ruling: Madrid commercial court, 3 Feb 2017 (The Local)

THE TEAM, AND WHO OWNS THE TECH

FRANCISCO ARREDONDO · FOUNDER

- 8 years of B2B sales across Europe, from rep to commercial director, plus 3 months as interim CEO; then senior sales in sports nutrition
- Rides kite, MTB and motocross
- Has drawn 350+ people to his own events with a new concept
- Knows the partners and riders on the network slide personally
- A creative crew from his network: film, photo, design, VFX
- Amsterdam, Barcelona and Tarifa; B.A. International Business

THE TECH

- Custom code, no no-code builder
- Repository and every account held by the founder
- IP assigned to the company at incorporation
- Stack and costs documented
- Next: a CTO who owns the architecture, equity earned over time

Stack: Supabase (database), Stripe (payments), Open-Meteo (forecasts), GitHub (code and hosting)

THE ASK

€250K PRE-SEED

15 months of runway · convertible note or SAFE · cap set with the lead

€100K
40% · Product and tech

A CTO, founder pay

€62.5K
25% · Growth

Hosts, athletes, Nights

€37.5K
15% · City pilots

Community and partners

€25K
10% · Legal

Insurance, compliance

€25K
10% · Data and buffer

Forecasts, hosting

In 15 months: kite proven in 3 cities, 300 completed outings a month, 35% back within 30 days, 10 partners paying. Then the seed.

Riders and partners can join through one SPV · hello@hi8ctane.com

HARD QUESTIONS, STRAIGHT ANSWERS · 1

Isn’t this just a WhatsApp group?
Groups say who might go. We say which day, which spot, which car, what it costs, and route the pick-ups.

What happens in winter?
Catalonia rides all year. MTB and MX need no wind, and flat days sell plans and Nights.

Why would partners pay 15%?
We fill weekdays and quiet slots. Founding partners pay 0% on their first 20 riders.

Kite is a niche.
It’s where we start, on purpose: the hardest logistics. The engine already supports four more sports for later.

Why would riders pay?
A seat saves €4 to €30 a day on fuel. The Club is built to pay for itself on one partner booking.

Won’t Strava or a brand copy it?
They’re feeds and brands. This is local density: hubs, captains and partners, city by city, and neutral.

HARD QUESTIONS, STRAIGHT ANSWERS · 2

Who owns the tech?
The founder holds the code and every account; IP goes to the company. A CTO with real ownership comes next.

What if someone gets hurt?
We never teach. Rookies ride with a captain, partners carry their own cover, ours is budgeted.

What does a year from now look like?
Kite proven in 3 cities, 300 outings a month, 35% back within 30 days, 10 partners paying.

Is the carpool legal?
Drivers only share costs, like BlaBlaCar, upheld in Madrid in 2017. Our fee is for the platform.

How do you get riders cheaply?
Events (350+ at the founder's own), athletes hosting crews, partners sending customers. Under €8 each.

How do investors get out?
Sport, travel and mobility platforms buy communities like this. Strava shows what social sport is worth.